CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 15: **That Little Square Box** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which pair is a correct cause and effect? 1

(a) Secretive behaviour -> narrator's suspicion
(b) Ten o'clock -> men's arrival
(c) Lifeboat -> the clicking
(d) Pigeon race -> narrator's boarding

2. If the narrator had asked the men politely about the box, the most likely result would be: 1

(a) a delay in the voyage **(b)** a quarrel
(c) a bomb scare **(d)** the mystery cleared quietly

3. Which sentence uses the past perfect correctly? 1

(a) He hides before the clock had struck ten.
(b) He has hid before the clock struck ten.
(c) He had hidden before the clock struck ten.
(d) He had hide before ten.

4. Which is the best title alternative reflecting the theme? 1

(a) The Winning Boat **(b)** The Captain's Day
(c) A Needless Panic at Sea **(d)** A Quiet Voyage

5. The author mostly uses which point of view? 1

(a) first person **(b)** omniscient
(c) second person **(d)** third person limited

6. Which word means the opposite of 'secretive'? 1

(a) silent **(b)** open **(c)** nervous **(d)** clever

7. What lesson can a modern student draw from the story? 1

(a) Never travel alone
(b) Always trust the first impression
(c) Avoid keeping birds
(d) Verify information before sharing alarming news

8. Which phrase in the story, as a comparison, shows his fear exaggerates? 1

(a) the sea was calm **(b)** the box looked like a pistol case
(c) the captain was kind **(d)** the ship was large

9. In 'The men were silent about the box', 'silent' is closest to: 1

(a) angry **(b)** loud **(c)** happy **(d)** uncommunicative

10. Which expression closest matches the narrator's mistake? 1

(a) killing two birds with one stone **(b)** jumping to conclusions

(c) letting the cat out of the bag **(d)** breaking the ice

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why might the author have set the story on a ship? 2

12. How does the ten o'clock deadline work in the plot? 2

13. Rewrite in reported speech: 'I will jump out,' thought the narrator. 2

14. How does the story show the danger of rumours? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Analyse the role of the captain, who never appears. 3

16. Compare the narrator's view of the box with the truth. 3

17. What role does humour play in teaching the lesson? 3

OR

Write a note on the effect of the countdown scene. 3

18. Write a note on how the story criticises prejudice. 3

OR

Describe the story's structure: beginning, middle, end. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. How do the details of the box and the men's behaviour contribute to a theme of misjudgment? 5

OR

What lessons about communication does the story offer? 5

20. Compare this story with 'Saving the Gharial' as examples of how fear shapes human behaviour. 5

OR

Design a short script for a skit based on the story. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND